

**RECORD OF PROCEEDINGS FOR THE GOVERNING BODY
OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE**

Office of City Clerk

March 5, 2026

The Governing Body of the City of Cheyenne convened in a special meeting on this date beginning at 6:00 p.m. in City Council Chambers for the purpose of collective labor bargaining with the Cheyenne Professional Fire Fighters, International Association of Fire Fighters, Local No. 279. Present were: MAYOR – Patrick Collins; COUNCIL MEMBERS – Mr. Esquibel, Mr. Laybourn, Mr. Moody, Mr. Segrave (via Zoom), Mr. White and Mr. Wolfe. Absent: Dr. Aldrich, Dr. Emmons and Dr. Rinne. Also present: Kylie Soden, City Clerk; John Brodie, City Attorney; Amber Ash, Mayor’s Chief of Staff; Robin Lockman, City Treasurer and Chief Andrew Dykshorn and Deputy Chief Don Wood, Cheyenne Fire Rescue. The pledge of allegiance was recited.

Mayor Collins advised he would entertain a motion to go into executive session. Pursuant to Wyoming State Statute §16-4-405(a)(x), Mr. Wolfe moved to meet in executive session, seconded by Mr. Esquibel. Motion carried. Voting “yes” – all members of the governing body present. The following staff members were in attendance: Amber Ash, Mayor’s Chief of Staff; John Brodie, City Attorney; Robin Lockman, City Treasurer; Kylie Soden, City Clerk and Chief Andrew Dykshorn and Deputy Chief Don Wood, Cheyenne Fire Rescue. [City Clerk note: audio and video recording of the special meeting was stopped; Executive Session convened at 6:05 p.m. in the Mayor’s conference room]

Following closure of the executive session, Mayor Collins reconvened the special meeting at 6:40 p.m.

Chris Thoms, President, Local #279, expressed appreciation for the labor-management meetings that take place in advance of contract negotiation meetings. He stated the Union’s primary goal is to address firefighter wages and presented wage comparisons for firefighter positions in Wyoming, Colorado, Montana, and South Dakota. Mr. Thoms indicated it is the Union’s position that Cheyenne firefighter compensation falls behind regional standards. Upon a request for clarification on the jurisdictions used for wage comparisons, Mr. Thoms provided additional information and stated that Cheyenne competes with departments along the Front Range. Mayor Collins stated that Wyoming communities are the most appropriate peer comparisons and noted the City has not experienced significant recruitment or retention issues in recent years. Mr. Thoms indicated the Union’s analysis includes both starting and top-out wages and that Cheyenne falls behind some communities in top-out compensation.

Discussion continued regarding differences in municipal funding structures, statewide compensation averages, top-out wages, identification of appropriate peer communities with similar tax structures and populations, and the number of applicants for entry-level firefighter positions.

Submitted by,

Kylie Soden,
City Clerk

This notice is available in alternative, accessible formats upon request.

Published: Wyoming Tribune-Eagle
March 11, 2026